AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
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SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A approved: 9 October 2026
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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Richards Bay Minerals / Rio Tinto × ASCO

Richards Bay Coastal Stewards: Community Dune, Estuary and Environmental Learning Action

Requested CSI investment: R200,000

Proposed implementation area: Richards Bay and selected host-community areas in the King Cetshwayo District, KwaZulu-Natal, subject to RBM/community/municipal confirmation and site permissions.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Richards Bay Minerals / Rio Tinto** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Richards Bay Coastal Stewards: Community Dune, Estuary and Environmental Learning Action**. The proposed request is **R200,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Richards Bay Coastal Stewards: Community Dune, Estuary and Environmental Learning Action in Richards Bay and selected host-community areas in the King Cetshwayo District, KwaZulu-Natal, subject to RBM/community/municipal confirmation and site permissions., benefiting Residents and community volunteers in participating host-community areas, with a focus on youth and local schools, environmental educators, community-based organisations and traditional/municipal stakeholders; final beneficiary numbers and sites to be confirmed through consultation. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Richards Bay Minerals / Rio Tinto's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R200,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
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Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Richards Bay Coastal Stewards: Community Dune, Estuary and Environmental Learning Action

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
Richards Bay and selected host-community areas in the King Cetshwayo District, KwaZulu-Natal, subject to RBM/community/municipal confirmation and site permissions.

Target beneficiaries
Residents and community volunteers in participating host-community areas, with a focus on youth and local schools, environmental educators, community-based organisations and traditional/municipal stakeholders; final beneficiary numbers and sites to be confirmed through consultation.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: establish 4 locally agreed community coastal-action sites or stewardship events, subject to permissions and baseline assessment.
- Proposed: train 40 youth/community participants in coastal ecosystem care, safe waste prevention, indigenous vegetation stewardship and citizen observation methods.
- Proposed: deliver 8 environmental learning sessions for local schools or youth groups, with accessible locally relevant materials.
- Proposed: complete 4 documented community clean-up, habitat-care or dune/estuary awareness actions and record participation, waste removed or vegetation-care activities using a simple monitoring log.
- Proposed: produce one baseline-and-closeout report with photographs, attendance, lessons, safeguarding evidence and recommendations for continuation; all targets are proposals, not completed results.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Richards Bay Minerals / Rio Tinto?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- RBM operates in northern KwaZulu-Natal around Richards Bay and identifies Mbonambi, Sokhulu, Mkhwanazi and Dube as host communities; its official page says RBM is a joint venture in which Rio Tinto holds 74%.
- RBM states that it works with government, suppliers and host communities and reported R72 million in community investment in 2024; this is a company-reported figure, not a commitment to ASCO.
- RBM mines coastal sand dunes and reports more than 3,600 hectares rehabilitated with native plants and trees, with the programme intended to restore coastal dune forest and ecosystem functions.
- Rio Tinto's communities approach emphasises transparent, inclusive and culturally appropriate engagement, management of social, economic, environmental, cultural and human-rights impacts, and strategic, outcomes-focused partnerships; its stated target is for 70% of total social investment to be through such partnerships by 2027.
- The RBM Social and Labour Plan (2025-2029) covers the King Cetshwayo-area development context and records community-consulted priorities, including education infrastructure and local development projects; it does not establish that an external NGO grant is available.
- Rio Tinto's sustainability framework expressly includes environment and nature, biodiversity, land, water, communities, social and economic benefit, and local procurement.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R120,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R16,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R12,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R16,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R14,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R14,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R8,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R200,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R200,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Official RBM contact listed by Rio Tinto: The Farm RBM, PO Box 401, Richards Bay 3900, South Africa; telephone +27 35 901 3111. The reviewed official pages did not provide a dedicated CSI application email or application portal. ASCO can make an initial enquiry through this RBM route and provide its own contact +27 76 757 5773 and website https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- No official public RBM/Rio Tinto external CSI application form, open call, eligibility rule or deadline was located in the reviewed sources; confirm the correct internal process before submitting.
- The official RBM page reports community investment at company level but does not say that environmental NGOs, ASCO or this type of project is eligible for funding.
- Because RBM identifies specific host communities and the SLP is structured around statutory/local planning and consultation, confirm geographic eligibility, community consent, municipal/traditional-authority permissions and any required environmental approvals.
- Section 18A receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for ASCO?s two approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability. This proposal does not represent a completed donation or tax deduction.
- A R200,000 request may need a detailed budget, governance and safeguarding documents, monitoring indicators, evidence of PBO/NPC status, bank/tax documentation and a clear maintenance/exit plan; these requirements were not confirmed in the official sources reviewed.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Richards Bay Minerals / Rio Tinto** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.riotinto.com/en/operations/africa/richards-bay-minerals
2. https://www.riotinto.com/en/sustainability/communities
3. https://www.riotinto.com/en/sustainability
4. https://www.riotinto.com/-/media/Content/Documents/Operations/RBM/RT-RBM-Social-and-labour-plan.pdf
5. https://www.riotinto.com/en/utility/contact

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.